F3 BUILDING SURVEYORS

BUILDING SURVEY REPORT

The Co-Proprietors per Trinity Factors

57 – 59 Caledonian Crescent, James Square, Edinburgh
Project Number: 21049
Date: 7-Jun-21
Revision: Not applicable

F3 BUILDING SURVEYORS
99 Giles Street, Edinburgh EH6 6BZ
0131 554 8050 | **f3surveyors.com**

57 – 59 CALEDONIAN CRESCENT, JAMES SQUARE, EDINBURGH

BUILDING SURVEY REPORT

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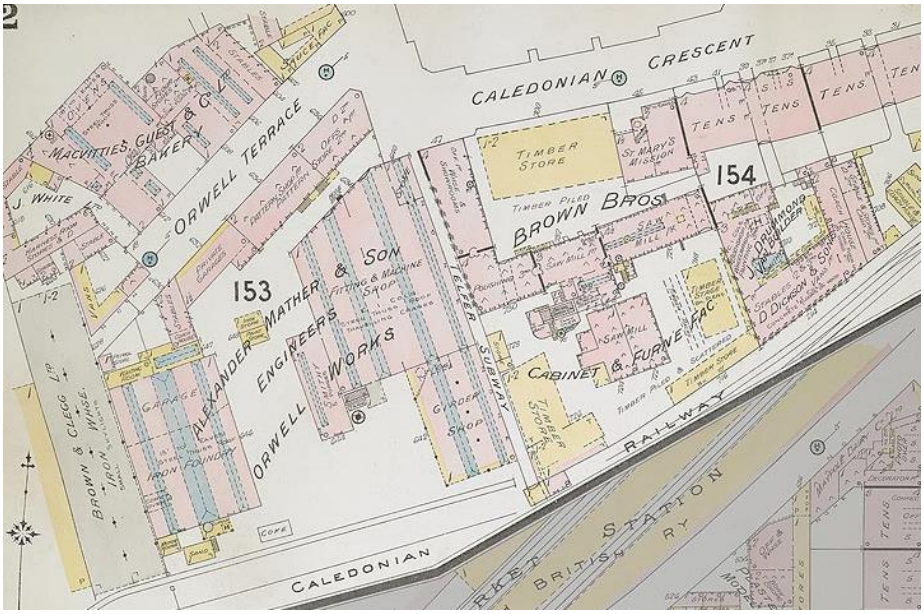
This report has been prepared by F3 Building Surveyors Limited with all reasonable skill, care and diligence, within the terms of the Contract with the Client. The report is confidential to the Client and F3 Building Surveyors Limited accepts no responsibility of whatever nature to third parties to whom this report may be made known.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. On behalf of The Co-Proprietors per Trinity Factors, we were requested to undertake a building fabric survey to the roof area of the property comprising 57 – 59 Caledonian Crescent, part of the James Square development, Edinburgh.

1.2. We undertook our survey on 6th May 2021, this was undertaken by David Bonar, MRICS, Chartered Building Surveyor and Sally Orr, MRICS, Chartered Building Surveyor.

1.3. The property comprises a flatted residential block within a larger development, the block in question is over three floors. Our understanding is that the properties are on the site of a former timber store and sawmill / furniture works (see map below). The property is not a listed building and neither is within a Conservation Area.



1.4. The property appears to be traditionally constructed with a wet dash wall finish, slated mansard sections at the top floor and the roof is of a flat roof construction.

1.5. The property is located on Caledonian Crescent, Edinburgh.

1.6. We were given access to the following areas:

1. INTRODUCTION (cont)

1.6.1. External fabric: We were able to undertake a ground level inspection of the elevations.

1.6.2. Roof coverings: We were able to undertake an inspection via access through the common stair hatch to block 57 to the flat roof coverings.

1.6.3. External curtilage: Not applicable for the purpose of our survey.

1.6.4. Internally we accessed flat 57/6 to view water ingress to rear bedroom.

1.7. Areas of no access: We gained access to all relevant areas for the purposes of the survey.

1.8. For the purposes of the report, the front elevation to the property on Caledonian Crescent is assumed to face north. All references to left hand side and right hand side are taken when viewing the relevant elevation from external facing the building.

1.9. We were not provided with any Health and Safety file nor the Operation & Maintenance Manual for the building. We have not been provided with any information for example builders estimates or the like.

1.10. Please note that this report is not intended for issue to contractors for pricing works. In the event that the owners decide to proceed with the works we would strongly recommend that full and comprehensive tender documentation be prepared, we can undertake this if required.

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS

2.1. The building is generally in a good condition however the roof coverings now require some repair:

2.1.1. Flat roof: The flat roof comprises a mastic asphalt finish, this is generally a hardwearing good quality roof covering, lasting 50 plus years. The roof drains from the mid point to the platform edge with slatework mansard section. The mastic asphalt appears to have had an aggregate finish (we have assumed limestone chips) laid over, these are no longer present and have possibly either been removed or simply been blown off over the years, this is a common finish to asphalt roof coverings. The roof has a solar reflective paint applied, the asphalt is now breaking up in places.

2.1.2. Generally, the flat roof does not have any blisters or the like, the main defect is cracking and opening up at upstands as well as the poor condition of the perimeter edge, this is a typical defect in mastic asphalt. At the time of our inspection, it was raining and there were no significant areas of ponding or the like to the roof, the roof "breaks its back" at the centre point and has a slight fall to the eaves. This fall is slightly less than 1:80, i.e. is slightly less than would be of a new build standard however still has a fall.

Photo 01 – General view of the roof

Photo 02 – Finish breaking up.

2.1.3. The mastic asphalt requires repairs including at the upstands where it has began to sag and crack, the finish at the edges is a poor finish with sections which have dripped down the leadwork cover flashing with areas which have been left short and sections which have begun to break up.

Photo 03 – Cracking at upstand.

Photo 04 – Finish breaking up at the platform edge.

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS (cont)

Photo 05 – Poor finish at perimeter, piece of asphalt detached.

Photo 06 – Repairs required to vent pipe.

2.1.4. Due to the detailing at the perimeters, we are unable to determine whether or not the deck is insulated, to confirm this, a core test can be undertaken and thereafter waterproofed.

2.1.5. The flat roof covering has had a solar reflective finish provided and this is now at the end of its useful life.

2.1.6. To the various vent pipes there are open joints and to one in particular the flashing is uplifting and requires to be sealed.

2.2. Leadwork: There are no lead cover flashings at the upstand, we would recommend that these are provided to provide the waterproof finish.

2.3. Copes: To the east most section of the property, at the gable end, there are pre cast copes, the pointing to these is missing to a number of joints and the copes themselves have began to become frost damaged, we would recommend that works are undertaken to these including re-pointing in the short term. In the medium term we have included for these to be clad in felt as part of the roofing works.

Photo 07 – Open / missing pointing to copes.

Photo 08 – Cracking to render at block 61

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS (cont)

2.4. Roof lights: There are 5nr roof lights larger in size 900 x 900mm and 3nr at 700 x 700mm, these are in a fair condition, at the time of flat roofing works in the medium term, we have included to replace these. We would note to the common stair access hatch that a strut is provided to allow safe access / egress as the hatch is heavy and is unable to be kept open.

2.5. Mansard slated sections: These are in a fair condition, and we would recommend these are annually inspected and any slipped slates are replaced when required. We have included for this within our budget costs.

2.6. Cracking to elevations: To the block at 61 we noted cracking to the elevation at high level, with some bossed sections (hollow when tapped), we noted throughout the development cracking to elevations and as such a further survey is advised to the elevations.

2.7. Common Stair: Although outwith our remit, we noted hairline cracking to the Western Approach road wall within the common stair. We recommend this is monitored and if increases in width, further inspection be carried out by a structural engineer.

2.8. Slatework to block 55: We noted slipped slates to the adjacent block slatework at high level, we have referred this to Trinity Factors separately. No costs are included within this report.

2.9. Flat 57/6: We inspected the flat as the resident noted water ingress to the bedroom facing the western approach road in February 2021. The resident noted there had not been any further ingress following an initial visit by a roofing contractor.

Photo 09 – Slatework requiring attention to block 55.

Photo 10 – Previous water ingress to flat 57/6

3. RECOMMENDED WORKS

3.1. Our recommendations would be to undertake the repairs as required to the following areas:

RED PRIORITY: IMMEDIATE / SHORT TERM (YEARS 1-2):

3.2. In terms of immediate / short term actions we would recommend the following:

3.2.1. Asbestos: We have included for an asbestos refurbishment survey to the roof prior to repairs.

3.2.2. Undertake repairs to the mastic asphalt by an approved contractor to maintain the water tightness of the properties. We would note that we are aware of only one contractor who is currently able to undertake repairs to mastic asphalt, Lenaghen Roofing Services Ltd within the local area.

3.2.3. Provide a lead cover flashing to the west most elevation.

3.2.4. Point up the existing concrete copes.

3.2.5. Cracking within common stair, we would recommend this is monitored.

AMBER PRIORITY: MEDIUM TERM (YEARS 3-5):

3.3. In terms of medium term actions, we would recommend the following:

3.3.1. We would recommend that the roof is overlaid with a felt roof covering or overcoated with a liquid plastic covering (both are similar in price and guarantee length), and subject to core testing, provision of additional insulation to improve the energy efficiency of the properties. At this time, this would include to overclad the concrete copes in felt to provide the waterproof finish.

3.3.2. Associated works with any insulation upgrading would be to increase the upstand / kerb of the roof lights and any vent pipe penetrations. We would recommend at this time to replace the roof lights to provide a full system finish.

GREEN PRIORITY: LONGER TERM (YEARS 6-10):

3.4. In terms of longer term actions, we would recommend the following:

3.4.1. Assuming the works are carried out in the short and medium term as recommended in the longer term.

4. CONCLUSION

4.1. In conclusion, based on our survey, repairs are required in the short term to the roof, and also in the medium term.

4.2. We refer you to our budget costs which highlight the short and medium term repairs required.

4.3. If you wish our further input or assistance in this regard, we would be delighted to do so.

4.4. We thank you for asking us to assist.

Prepared by F3 Building Surveyors Ltd.
7-Jun-21

Prepared by:	**SO**	Date:
Checked by:	**DB**	**7-Jun-21**

APPENDIX 1 – BUDGET COSTS

Description	Quantity	Units	Rate	Total	RED: Short Term	AMBER: Medium Term	GREEN: Longer Term
57-59 Caledonian Crescent: James Square, Roof Coverings							
SUPERSTRUCTURE							
Roof							
Roof coverings							
Asphalt flat roof covering							
Carry out patch repairs, to cracked and open sections.	279	m2	10	2,790.00	2,790.00		
Solar Reflective paint to be applied	279	m2	15	4,185.00	4,185.00		
Overlay with mineral felt	279	m2	90	25,110.00		25,110.00	
Extra Over Insulation	279	m2	50	13,950.00		13,950.00	
Increase upstand to roof lights etc.	1	Item	3000	3,000.00		3,000.00	
Seal around vent pipes	6	No	40	240.00	240.00		
Copes							
Concrete copes - repoint and repair in short term	9	m	50	450.00	450.00		
Leadwork							
Provide Lead Coverflashings	9	m	65	585.00	585.00		
Slatework							
Allowance for refixing small number of mansard slates.	25	No	15	375.00	375.00		
Roof lights							
Replace							
900 x 900mm	2	No	800	1,600.00		1,600.00	
700 x 700mm	3	No	650	1,950.00		1,950.00	
Provide strut - allow for hatch to remain open safely whilst on the roof.	1	No	250.00	250.00	250.00		
PRELIMINARIES							
Facilitating Works							
Toxic / Hazardous / Contaminated Material Treatment							
Toxic / Hazardous Material Removal							
Asbestos Refurbishment Survey	1	Item	500	500.00	500.00		
Main Contractor's Preliminaries							
Temporary works							
Access Scaffolding							
Access tower for materials etc.	23	m2	18	414.00	414.00	414.00	
Edge Protection for perimeter	80	m	20	1,600.00	1,600.00	1,600.00	
Crash deck internally	5	No	150	750.00	750.00	750.00	
SUB-TOTAL CONSTRUCTION COSTS					**12,139.00**	**48,374.00**	**0.00**
PROFESSIONAL FEES					**1,213.90**	**4,837.40**	
VAT				**20%**	**2,670.58**	**10,642.28**	**0.00**
					16,023.5	**63,853.7**	**0.0**

APPENDIX 2 – STANDARD CONDITIONS

Content of the Report

In accordance with these terms the Surveyor will use his or her best endeavours to report upon:

a. The main aspects of the Property including assessing the site/location, the design, structural framework, fabric and services;

b. The grounds, boundaries and environmental aspects considered to affect the Property;

c. Any requirements for further investigation arising from the inspection.

Assumptions

Unless otherwise expressly agreed the Surveyor while preparing the Report will reasonably assume that:

a. The Building(s) (if for sale) is offered with vacant possession;

b. The Building(s) is connected to mains services with appropriate rights on a basis that is known and acceptable to the Client; and

c. Access to the Building(s) is as of right upon terms known and acceptable to the Client.

Scope of the inspection

A. Generally

a. The Surveyor will consider his or her advice carefully but is not required to advise on any matter the significance of which in relation to the Building(s) is not apparent at the time of inspection from the inspection itself.

b. The Surveyor will inspect diligently but is not required to undertake any action that would risk damage to the Building(s) or injury to himself, herself or any other party.

c. The Surveyor will not undertake any structural or other calculations.

d. The Surveyor will not produce a repair schedule, planned maintenance report, feasibility report or advise on design, procurement or project management unless expressly agreed with the client.

B. Accessibility

a. The Surveyor will inspect as much of the internal and external surface area of the building as is practicable but will not inspect those areas which are covered, unexposed or not reasonably accessible from within the site, or adjacent public areas.

b. The Surveyor is not required to move any obstruction to inspection including, but not limited to, fixtures, fittings and floor coverings.

c. The surveyor will not open up or cut into the building fabric without specific directions from the client. Such intrusive investigations, if instructed by the client, will be at the risk and liability of the client and will be assumed to be with agreement between the client and the building owner.

C. Floors

a. The Surveyor will lift accessible sample loose floorboards and trap doors, if any, which are not covered by heavy furniture, ply or hardboard, fitted carpets or other fixed floor coverings. The Surveyor will not attempt to cut or lift fixed floorboards or other floor fabric without the express permission of the owner.

D. Fixed covers or housings

a. The Surveyor will not attempt to remove securely fixed covers or housings without the express permission of the owner.

E. Roofs

a. The Surveyor will inspect the roof spaces if there is a safe working platform available to work from. Where no safe working platform or access is available, the roof spaces will not be inspected. Similarly, outer surfaces of the roof or adjacent areas will be inspected using binoculars, but will be excluded if they cannot be seen.

F. Boundaries, grounds and outbuildings

a. Where reasonable access is available the inspection will include boundaries, grounds and permanent outbuildings but will not include temporary buildings or structures.

G. Services

a. The Surveyor will carry out a visual inspection of the service installations where reasonably accessible. Drainage inspection covers will be lifted where they are reasonably accessible and it is safe and practicable to do so. No tests of the service installations will be carried out unless previously agreed, although general overall comments will be made where reasonably possible and practicable. The Surveyor will report if it is considered that tests are advisable. Specialist inspection of electrical installations or gas mains will not be undertaken.

H. Areas not inspected

a. The Surveyor will identify any areas which would normally be inspected but which he or she was unable to reasonably inspect.

I. Environmental and other issues

a. Particular noise, dust, flooding or contaminated land and disturbance affecting the Property will only be noted if it is reasonably significant at the time of the inspection or if specific investigation has been agreed between the Surveyor and the Client and confirmed in writing.

b. The Surveyor will report on any reasonably obvious health and safety hazards to the extent that they are apparent from elements of the Property considered as part of the inspection.

c. The Surveyor will not undertake a fire risk assessment or consider fire safety risks to the extent that they are apparent from elements of the property considered as part of the inspection.

J. Hazardous materials

a. Unless otherwise expressly stated in the Report, the Surveyor will assume that no deleterious or hazardous materials or techniques have been used in the construction of the Property. However, the Surveyor will advise in the Report if, in his or her view, there is a likelihood that deleterious material has been used in the construction and specific enquiries should then be made or tests carried out by a specialist.

b. Subject to section B to page 1, the Surveyor, based upon a limited visual inspection, will note and advise upon the presence of lead water supply pipes and asbestos.

c. The Surveyor will advise in the Report if, to the best of his or her knowledge, the Property is in an area where, based on information published by the National Radiological Protection Board, there is a risk of radon. In such cases the Surveyor may advise that tests should be carried out to establish the radon level.

d. The Surveyor will endeavour to advise if there are transformer stations or overhead power lines which might give rise to an electromagnetic field, either over the subject Property or visible immediately adjacent to the Property. The Surveyor is not required to assess any possible effect on health or to report on any underground cables.

K. Ground conditions

a. The Surveyor will not be required to comment upon the possible existence of noxious substances, landfill or mineral extraction implications, or other forms of contamination, nor will the Surveyor advise on the adequacy of the substratum for any particular purpose unless geotechnical tests or specialist advice are commissioned by the client.

L. Consents, approvals and searches

a. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that the Building or site is not subject to any unusual or onerous restrictions, obligations or covenants which apply to the Property or affect the reasonable enjoyment of the Property.

b. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that all planning, Building Regulations and other consents required in relation to the Property have been obtained. The Surveyor will not verify whether such consents have been obtained. Any enquiries should be made by the Client or the Client's legal advisers. Drawings and specifications will not be inspected by the Surveyor unless otherwise previously agreed.

c. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that the Property is unaffected by any matters which would be revealed by a Local Search and replies to the usual enquiries, or by a Statutory Notice, and that neither the Property, nor its condition, its use or its intended use, is or will be unlawful.

M. Exclusions

a. We have not inspected woodwork or other parts of the structure which are covered, unexposed or inaccessible and we are therefore unable to report that any such part of the property is free from defect.

b. We must stress that we have not carried out any investigation to determine whether any high alumina cement was used during the construction of the building inspected and we are therefore unable to report that the building is free from risk in this respect. In view of the possible potential danger connected with high alumina cement we strongly recommend that the appropriate investigations, inspections and tests be carried out immediately by a suitably qualified engineer.